

LEADERSHIP PROFILE

STAVROULA PAPADAKI

Stanford MS&E · D1 Basketball Captain

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PURPOSE

“I lead by believing in people before they believe in themselves.”

CONDITIONS WHERE I DO MY BEST WORK

Behavior is a function of the person and their environment. (Cara Moyer, Airbnb — Leadership Lab) • I feel trusted and my judgment is respected

- The purpose behind the work is clear and genuinely matters
- I have space to prepare — I lead best when I have thought through the room
- The challenge is real and the stakes are high enough to matter

HOW I OPERATE ON TEAMS

Optimizer + emotional leader. (Annie Stancliffe, Faire — Leadership Lab)

- Prepare behind the scenes so the group can move forward together
- Notice what people need before they say it
- Drive toward clarity on direction, roles, and next steps
- Hold space — give people room to arrive at their own answers

LEADERSHIP EXAMPLES

Team Captain · Stanford NCAA D1 Women's Basketball · 2022–2026

Led a 15+ person roster through demanding seasons. Built trust with coaches and teammates by holding difficult conversations and creating an environment where people felt believed in.

U18 Greek National Championship · 3rd Place · 2021

Competed at 16 in an under-18 league with no expectation to lead. Stepped up when the team needed direction and helped finish 3rd nationally as underdogs.

Product Management Class Team · Stanford · Spring 2026

Led a 4-person team building a product for Stanford Athletics. Applied leadership without formal authority: designed intentional team gatherings, used AI to prepare and coordinate, and built shared direction around a real problem.